

glasstech, inc.

Service Bulletin

Customer Service Department

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Glasstech Control Systems and the Year 2000 Reference 014

There are widespread concerns over the advent of the year 2000, and its affect on computer controlled systems. This Service Bulletin will explain the effects of the year change from the year 1999 to the year 2000 for the Glasstech control systems in use. Although incorrect display and history by dates may occur, no adverse effects on furnace function are anticipated.

6809 Control Systems:

The 6809 control computer does not use the Time of Day Clock for any control functions. There should be no effect in the 6809 control system when the year changes from 1999 to 2000.

FLEXOS[®] Control Systems:

The FlexOS[®] based control program does not make use of the day or year information for process function. The display does show the date and time, however, and all existing systems will display incorrect dates after the year 2000. A software update to the operating system that will correct this defect is now available from Glasstech. **Do not attempt to manually set the year to 2000 in the CMOS setup or with the "Date" command without first acquiring this update.** Attempting to manually change the date past the year 1999 may result in resetting the CMOS, disrupting control system and furnace operations, and should **not** be performed. A software BIOS test will be available on our web site at www.glasstech.com.

PLC Control Systems:

The PLC based systems do not make use of the Time of Day Clock in the control code. There should be no effect in the PLC control system when the year changes from 1999 to 2000.

PC Front End (Factory Link[®]):

The Factory Link[®] system does not make use of the day or year information for process function. However, dates are used in process recording, error logging, and recipe maintenance and, in some cases, these dates will display incorrectly after the year 2000. Please contact Glasstech for updates, customized for your system, which will correct this display error. A software BIOS test will be available on our web site at www.glasstech.com.

PC Front End (Windows[®] Based Front End):

All PC systems that have been shipped from Glasstech for use on the WBFE front ends use various BIOS software and some of the older systems may fail BIOS year 2000 automatic rollover. Those systems that fail to handle this automatically will require a manual re-setting of the date after the year 2000. A software BIOS test will be available on our web site at www.glasstech.com.

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